CHESS 2026/2027 Grades 9-12 Course Descriptions

Drama (grades 4-12); 8:15

During this two-semester course, students will learn how to put on a theatrical performance. Each week we will learn various acting skills and terms. These include how to project our voices, understanding how and when to move on stage, becoming your character, and many other things! We will use theatrical games and exercises to help us learn these things - all leading up to our performance in the spring! Students will also learn that all media, including stage performances, should be for the glory of God. Our play will give us plenty of opportunities to talk about the gospel and growing in Godly maturity.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: good reading skills
- Texts (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): none
- Homework: two to three hours per week. Students should expect to commit to weekly memorization/working on lines once assigned.
- Internet needed for homework: Some internet use may be needed.
- Material fee: $10

Principles of Bible Study; 8:15

This two-semester class designed for freshmen Diploma Program students will equip students with the principles of Hermeneutics as well as establish the importance of such doctrines as Inerrancy, Inspiration, Sufficiency, as well as an epistemic confidence in interpretation. It will discuss various methods of interpretation, seeking to give the students the tools necessary to work through hard passages and to allow the Bible to change them as they grow in knowledge through their interaction with Scripture.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (H).
- Prerequisites: high school level reading and comprehension
- Text Required (sourced and purchased by family): *Grasping God's Word: a Hands-on Approach to Reading, Interpreting, and Applying the Bible*. 4th Edition - by J. Scot Duvall, J Daniel Hays; ISBN-10: 0310109175
- Homework: 1 - 2 hours per week
- Internet Needed for Homework: only for uploading assignments
- Material fee: none

British Literature: 8:15 **(Please note: This class has been rescheduled from a Tuesday/Thursday, 9:15 class to a Thursday-only class at 8:15. Please see the revised description below. Thank you.)**

WWII; 8:15

In this two-semester course, we will learn about the Second World War from beginning to end. This will mostly be a review of the basic narrative of the war as well as a more detailed analysis of select events and concepts. This will be a reading and writing-intensive course and will involve significant in-class discussion.

Course Details:

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: none
- Text(s) (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): *The Second World War*, Martin Gilbert, ISBN #0-8050-1788-7, no specific edition needed
- Homework: approx. 2 hours per week; more hours may be needed for writing assignments
- Internet needed for homework: yes
- Material fee: none

Speech & Debate; Tuesday, 8:15; Thursday 2:15

This two-semester course will teach students how to develop strong arguments using clear logic and the resources readily available in their own thinking. Students will learn how to communicate persuasively, appeal appropriately to people's emotions, and strengthen their credibility through thoughtful communication, effective use of humor, and well-chosen quotations.

The course will also focus on analyzing and critiquing opposing viewpoints while helping students develop the skills needed to organize and present their own arguments in both informal and formal debate. Much of the class will be interactive, incorporating Socratic discussion, structured debate, and regular student participation. With the amount of discussion and engagement involved, it may end up being one of your favorite classes.

Homework will be assigned weekly and will typically include reading, workbook definitions, and exercises designed to help students think through logic and argument structure. Quizzes and tests will be minimal. Grades will primarily be based on effort, participation in debates, and completion of assigned homework. The class will use *Everyday Debate & Discussion* by Dr. Shelly Johnson.

Course Details

- 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H). **Please note: Tuesday class time is 2:15; Thursday class time is 8:15**
- Prerequisite: Students must be in 9–12th grade.
- Text: The teacher will purchase the books for each student. Please do not purchase your own copies. There is a $45 fee for this class (see below); this fee covers the purchase of the book used during the entire school year. Students do not need to purchase any other books for this class, and there are no additional material fees.
- Homework: 20–40 pages of reading per week. Students will also be expected to write papers as part of the course requirements.
- Internet needed for homework: Internet access may be required.
- Book fee: $45 (This fee covers the cost of the book used for the full year of this course.)

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US Civil War; 9:15

This two-semester course is designed to give students an in-depth study of the US Civil War era. The class will examine the many years of events that led to the War Between the States. Attention will be given to the actual battles, politics, and life in general during this era. Students will read, analyze, and discuss the material given. Special emphasis will be given to the importance of discussing material to facilitate a better understanding of historical concepts as well as the ability to discuss events within their historical context.

Course Details

- 14-week semesters; Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: none
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): *Battle Cry of Freedom,* by James McPherson ISBN:978-0-19-516895-2
    - Colorado Heritage has a limited number of this textbook available for a donation. Please contact the office at office@coloradoheritage.org for details.
- Homework:1-2 hours of homework a week - until paper writing time 😁 .
- Internet needed for homework:
  Internet only required for submitting papers by email.
- Material fee: none

British Literature; ~~9:15~~ **(Pls note: this class has been moved to a Thursday-only class; 8:15)**

This two-semester course will explore several of the British literary greats. We will take a deep dive into specific books, with the goal of not only becoming well-versed in author and style specific to the timeframe and region of the world, but also having the students come to love this glorious genre by reading these worthy samplings, writing about them, and discussing them.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Course meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisites: Students need to commit to reading large chunks of literature selections weekly. Some are difficult because of an older language style, but all are extremely worthwhile.
- Required:
    - Please bring your textbook to every class time.
    - Please bring a loose-leaf notebook with page protectors—this class has many handouts that need to be organized for easy reference. Handouts need to be filed in the loose-leaf notebook for easy reference, and students will be tested on their contents.
- MLA format is preferred for essays and papers.
    - Texts (sourced and purchased by family): T BD
- Homework: reading, writing, etc.
- Internet needed: possibly to look up essay formats/No material fee

General Chemistry w/Lab; 9:15

In this two-semester course, we will explore the wonders of the chemical world around us. We will learn about atomic structure and types and chemical bonds and discover just how much information is hiding in the Periodic Table. And that's just the beginning! Throw in thermodynamics, acid/base chemistry, rate kinetics, and stoichiometry, and we will have a full, but fun, year!

Course Details

- 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisite: Algebra 1
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): Apologia *Exploring Creation with Chemistry*; Edition: 3rd (white cover) ISBN:978-1-940110-2-57
    - Colorado Heritage has a limited quantity of this textbook available for a donation. Please contact the office at office@coloradoheritage.org for details.
- Homework: 3 - 4 hours per week
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Lab Fee: $20

OT Survey; Tuesday, 9:15; Thursday, 2:15

This two-semester class will serve as a significant survey of the Old Testament portions of the Scripture. The goal is to equip students to know the contents of each book of the Old Testament as well as have a broad understanding of the key themes, characters, and doctrines that the Old Testament teaches.

Class Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
    - **Tuesday class meets at 9:15**
    - **Thursday class meets at 2:15**
- Prerequisite: high school level reading and comprehension.
- Texts required (sourced and purchased by family):
    - *The World and the Word: an Introduction to the Old Testament* – By Eugene H. Merrill, Mark F. Rooker, Michael A. Grisanti; ISBN-10: 0805440313
- Homework: 4 - 5 hours per week
- Internet Needed for Homework: Only for uploading Bible Digests
- Material fee: none

CHESS 2026/2027 Grades 9-12 Course Descriptions

JH/HS Art: Story/Illustration Art; 10:15

The focus of this class will be to learn consistent style and layout. When doing illustrations and telling a story with art, themes, color and style are important. The purpose of this class will be to work through the process of storytelling in pictures and art. God has made the world very delightful to the eyes. We want to pair good stories with good art to capture true balance.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: none
- Texts: none
- Homework: two to four hours per homework project
- Internet needed for homework: It may be helpful.
- Material fee: $10

U.S. Government; 10:15

This course provides a comprehensive study of the foundations, structure, and function of the United States government within the context of a Biblical worldview. Students will examine the philosophical and Scriptural principles that inform the concept of civil government and explore the development of the American constitutional republic.

Through the study of the Constitution and the structure of the federal government, students will analyze the roles and responsibilities of the Legislative, Executive, and Judicial branches, as well as the system of checks and balances designed to preserve liberty. The course will also examine political parties, elections, and the responsibilities of citizens within a free society.

Students will be encouraged to think critically about current events and modern political issues by evaluating them through the lens of constitutional principles, historical context, and biblical truth. Homework will be assigned weekly and will include regular reading from the textbook along with section reviews, chapter activities, and occasional research assignments.

Course Details

- 14-week semesters. Class meets two days per week (T/H).
- Prerequisite: Students must be in 9–12th grade.
- Text (sourced and purchased by the family, please purchase prior to class):
  - *American Government, 4th Edition* — BJU Press (ISBN: 978-1-62856-424-2).
- Homework: 20–40 pages of reading per week along with section reviews and chapter activities.
- Internet needed for homework: Internet access may be required.
- Material fee: $10 (This fee covers classroom materials and instructional resources used during the course.)

Algebra II; 10:15

In this two-semester course, we will continue to work through the skills learned in Algebra 1 and Geometry as well as learn to work with imaginary and complex numbers, understand and apply the binomial theorem, learn how to solve basic quadratic equations with the quadratic formula, learn how to solve equations with three unknowns, apply analytic geometry to conic sections, and more. Your student will need to have access to Google Classroom using a Colorado Heritage Gmail account. If you do not already have a Colorado Heritage Gmail account, the office will set one up for you. If you have a Colorado Heritage Gmail account and have forgotten your password, please contact the office. *Pre-class assignments will be given in the syllabus and will be due through Google Classroom before the first class. Syllabi will be available in the Praxi Parent Portal by end of July.*

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisites: Your student should have successfully completed Algebra I and Geometry.
- Texts (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): *Math-U-See Algebra II Instruction Manual and DVD (student workbook and test booklet are not necessary)*
- Other required material: graph paper, regular lined paper, ruler, pencil
- Homework: 3 to 5 hours per week
- Internet needed for homework: Yes
- Material fee: $6

Heritage Chorale; 11:15

Heritage Chorale/High School Choir (ages 12+) This is a two-semester class. Each semester, we will perform a themed concert with songs from a variety of eras and genres. We focus on vocal technique, sight-reading, and performance values. No audition is required. Students are required to attend the end-of-semester performance which is generally scheduled for the final week of the semester. The date of the performance is scheduled by the beginning of the semester.

Class Details

- Two 14-week semesters.
- Meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: None
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): None; music will be provided by the teacher.
- Homework: None
- Internet needed for homework: No
- Material fee: none

CHESS 2026/2027 Grades 9-12 Course Descriptions

NT Survey; 11:15

This two-semester class will serve as a significant survey of the New Testament portions of the Scriptures. The goal is to equip students to know the contents of each book of the New Testament as well as have a broad understanding of the key themes, characters, and doctrines that the New Testament teaches.

Class Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (H).
- Prerequisite: high school-level reading and comprehension.
- Text required (sourced and purchased by family):
  - *The Cradle, the Cross, and the Crown: An Introduction to the New Testament* – by Dr. Andreas J. Köstenberger Ph.D., L. Scott Kellum, and Charles L Quarles; ISBN-10: 1433684004 Homework: 3-4 hours per week
- Internet Needed for Homework: Only for uploading Bible Digest
- Material fee: none

Research and Composition, 1:15

In this two-semester class, students will engage in various activities designed to develop research and writing skills. Emphasis will be placed on developing a quality composition with citations using MLA and Chicago Style. Although most compositions will be essay length or shorter, one full research paper* is required for each semester. Strunk & White's *The Elements of Style,* as well as the library and internet access are required. *Diploma Program students may opt to submit their Biographical Sketch as their spring semester research paper.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisite: a basic high school composition course
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): *The Elements of Style,* by Strunk & White (4th edition or newer)
- Homework: 2 - 3 hours per week
- Internet needed for homework: yes
- Material fee: none

Algebra 1; 1:15

In this two-semester course, we will delve into Algebra 1 using the Math-U-See curriculum. Through the completion of the course, we will find that God has created numbers to help bring order to our world. We will cover the algebraic concepts of distributive property, graphing a line, graphing inequalities, addition and multiplication of polynomials, factoring trinomials with coefficients, solving equations with factoring, and many more. ***Pre-class assignments will be given in the syllabus and will be due on the first day of classes. Syllabi will be available in the Praxi Parent Portal by the end of July.***

Class Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H).
- Prerequisite: Your student should have successfully completed Pre-Algebra with Math-U-See OR completed the Math-U-See Placement Tool to determine if Algebra 1 is the correct level. You can find the placement tool at https://placement.mathusee.com/.
- Required Textbook/Material:
  - *Math-U-See Algebra 1: Legacy Instruction Manual* set which comes with lesson-by-lesson text instructions, detailed solutions, and the DVD with lesson-by-lesson video instruction.
  - *Algebra 1: Legacy Student Workbook* set with lesson-by-lesson worksheets, review pages, honors pages, and tests.
- Please ensure that the edition you are purchasing has 35 lessons. (This edition was released in the second half of 2009.) *Older editions with 34 lessons should not be purchased.* (There is also a new Algebra 1 curriculum sold by Math-U-See, that is NOT written by Mr. Demme, called *Algebra 1: Principles of Secondary Mathematics*. That is not what you want to purchase. Mr. Demme's *Algebra 1: Legacy* is the correct curriculum.)
- Optional Textbook and Required Materials:
  - Your student may find it very helpful to have the full *Algebra 1: Legacy Universal Set* which includes all the block kits used.
  - Other required material: graph paper, regular lined paper, ruler, pencil
- Bring to each class: graph paper, regular lined paper, ruler, pencil, and student workbook. *On the first day of class, please bring your test book.*
- Homework: 3–5 hours per week
- Internet needed for homework: yes, occasionally
- Material fee: none

Advanced Chamber Ensemble; 2:15

In this two-semester class, we will learn a combination of standard chamber music and hymn arrangements to perform in conjunction with the chorale performance. Material is selected seasonally or topically. Students are required to attend the end-of-semester performance, which is usually scheduled for the last week of each semester. We announce the specific dates by the beginning of each semester.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- Prerequisite: Students must be able to play an orchestral instrument, be able to read music, and play at least at an advanced beginner level (approx. Suzuki, level 3).
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): None; music will be provided by the teacher.
- Homework: None required, although practicing at home may be beneficial for some students.
- Internet needed for homework: no
- Material fee: none

CHESS 2026/2027 Grades 9-12 Course Descriptions

Computer Graphics; 2:15

In this two-semester class, students will learn the basics of graphic design and how to use it practically. We will learn the fundamentals of color theory, fontology, sizing, and many other fun things. We will also create a mock business and design logos and learn how to use this art skill practically!
Students will be required to use CHESS-supplied computers for class/assignments related to this class - in the classroom, at CHESS, and at home. These computers are monitored by the school's computer safety app, even while in use at home. Please use the CHESS-supplied computer for all assignments related to this class, even when working on these assignments at home. For at-home personal computer use, please use your home computer.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (H)
- Prerequisite: none
- Text (sourced and purchased by family): *Graphic Design for Everyone: Understand the Building Blocks So You Can Do It Yourself,* by Cath Caldwell
- Homework: Students should expect to spend 1 - 2 hours each week working on their digital art projects and/or watching helpful video lectures.
- Internet needed for homework? Internet is required. The student will also need to have access to the free software, Canva. Premium subscription is not required.
- Technology fee (for this class): $75.00

Weight Training; **3:15**

This two-semester class will teach students how to properly train in weightlifting. Your student will learn the science behind physical fitness and will be taught how to continue on their own with as much or as little equipment as possible. Physical fitness training has proven to be an amazing and powerful outlet for young people as they face the many stresses of this life. Instruction will include not only encouragements to advance in physical fitness, but also in spiritual fitness.

Course Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets one day a week (T).
- **Class time** - 3:15 pm
- Prerequisite: none
- Texts (sourced & purchased by family; please purchase prior to class): none
- Homework: minimal, if any
- Internet needed for homework: yes
- Material fee: $5

OT Survey, 2:15

This two-semester class will serve as a significant survey of the Old Testament portions of the Scripture. The goal is to equip students to know the contents of each book of the Old Testament as well as have a broad understanding of the key themes, characters, and doctrines that the Old Testament teaches.

Class Details

- Two 14-week semesters. Class meets two days a week (T/H)*
- ***Please note:**
  - **Tuesday class meets at 9:15**
  - **Thursday class meets at 2:15**
- Prerequisite: high school level reading and comprehension.
- Texts required (sourced and purchased by family):
  - *The World and the Word: an Introduction to the Old Testament,* by Eugene H. Merrill, Mark F. Rooker, Michael A. Grisanti; ISBN-10: 0805440313
- Homework: 4 - 5 hours per week
- Internet Needed for Homework: Only for uploading Bible Digests
- Material fee: none